



mastercard
foundation

Shared Measures 2.0 Framework

Executive Summary

25 November 2025

Kindly read slide 2 for disclaimer

Disclaimer on Use of the Shared Measures 2.0 Presentation

This PowerPoint deck is intended **solely for presentation and communication purposes**. All content within the slides must **at all times** remain aligned with the *Shared Measures 2.0 Narrative Guide*, which serves as the **primary and authoritative source** on concepts, definitions, and measurement logic.

Given the possibility of accidental edits or formatting shifts within the PPT, **the Narrative Guide takes precedence** in all cases. If any discrepancy arises between the PPT and the Narrative Guide, users should defer to the Narrative Guide as the **official reference**.

1.1 About the Shared Measures 2.0

At the Mastercard Foundation, we advance **workforce development** and **entrepreneurship** by expanding access to education, skills and financial programs and services. Our Goal is to support **young women and men to secure and sustain dignified and fulfilling work** – enabling them to thrive and become drivers of transformative change, **sustained** over time **by strong systems and institutions**. This is the pathway through which we navigate towards our intended impact: *Sustained improvements in the quality of life for young women and men, broader socio-economic effects for their families and communities and the overall health of the economy and society at system level.*

The **Shared Measures 2.0 framework** enables the tracking, measurement, and assessment of our performance through **9 Key Measures**. These measures are intended **to be used as relevant and appropriate** to programs and platforms to support adaptive programming.

1.2 Relevance of Shared Measures for Programs & Partners

Why a Shared Measures Framework: A framework to guide the Foundation and its Partners in gathering evidence to support them in:

- Making informed decisions in designing and adapting to realize inclusive and sustainable impact
- Catalyzing and motivating collective action (within and external to the Foundation)
- Elevating the voices of young women and men in shaping and transforming growth and development agendas
- Being accountable (horizontally & vertically; internally & externally)

The insights will enable us to deepen our understanding of our journeys in:

- Unlocking barriers to access for young women and young men
- Enabling access to work, especially dignified and fulfilling work
- Improving the quality of life for youth, families and their communities
- Ensuring the longer-term endurance of impacts over time

1.3 Why did we Evolve Our Shared Measures Framework?

1

Purposeful Evolution:

We are evolving our shared measures to ensure a strategic approach that captures the nuanced interplay between program outputs, individual empowerment, and long-term institutional and systemic shifts.

2

Enhanced Clarity in Complexity:

This framework is designed to distill complex interactions into a clear, accessible format, allowing stakeholders at all levels to understand and engage with our impact pathways.

3

Focused on Real-World Outcomes:

By refining our measures, we are sharpening our focus on tangible outcomes that enhance access to finance, markets, and technology for youth, particularly young women.

4

Dynamic and Responsive:

As a living tool, this framework evolves with our organization's growth, learning from past experiences, such as baseline studies and strategic reviews, and adapting to future challenges and opportunities. [[see link to suggestions from country directors after the 2023 Rwanda PST workshop](#)]

5

Inclusivity as a Benchmark:

Ensuring inclusivity remains at the forefront, we are specifically enhancing measures that empower young people to have agency and voice, which is crucial for sustainable development.

2.0 Shared Measures 2.0

2.1 Overview of the Shared Measures 2.0 Framework

Nine Shared Measures guiding how we track progress and learning across programs

SM1

Individuals that received and benefited from one or more Foundation-supported work enabling interventions.

SM2

Foundation-supported young people transition into a higher level of education.

SM3

Representation of young people, particularly young women, in higher end value chains/sub-sectors with growing economic potential.

SM4

Foundation-supported enterprises growing and creating work opportunities for youth, particularly young women.

SM5

Foundation-supported youth accessing new, additional, or improved work (wage or self-employment).

SM6

Foundation-supported young people accessing dignified and fulfilling work.

SM7

Foundation-supported young people reporting improvement in their lives and livelihoods and that of their households.

SM8

Foundation's contribution to strengthening ecosystems to enable and accelerate inclusive and sustainable access to education and dignified and fulfilling work by young people at scale.

SM9

Extent to which partner institutions demonstrate stronger, more inclusive, and sustainable systems – with enhanced capacity to drive access education and dignified and fulfilling work for young women and men.

2.0 Shared Measures 2.0

2.2 Shared Measures 2.0 Framework: Measures and Metrics

Measures		Metrics	
SM 1	Individuals that received and benefited from one or more Foundation-supported work enabling interventions	SM 1.1	Number of individuals accessing work-enabling services (all categories)
		SM 1.2	Foundation-supported participants perceptions of relevance, quality and utility interventions
SM 2	Foundation-supported young people transition into a higher level of education	SM 2.1	% of Foundation-supported youth transitioning to the next level of education
SM 3	Representation of young people, particularly young women, in higher end value chains/sub-sectors with growing economic potential	SM 3.1	% and stories of Foundation supported youth accessing work in higher end value chains/sub sectors (prioritized by in Roadmaps/ Strategies)
SM 4	Foundation-supported enterprises growing and creating work opportunities for youth, particularly young women	SM 4.1	% of enterprises showing growth through increased revenue
		SM 4.2	% of enterprises showing growth through market expansion / diversification
		SM 4.3	Average # of work opportunities accessed by youth from Foundation-supported enterprises
SM 5	Foundation-supported youth accessing new, additional, or improved work (wage or self-employment)	SM 5.1	Number of employed youth (wage and self employment)
SM 6	Foundation-supported young people accessing dignified and fulfilling work	SM 6.1	% of Youth accessing Dignified & Fulfilling Work
		SM 6.2	Youth experiences in accessing dignified & fulfilling work
SM 7	Foundation-supported young people reporting improvement in their lives and livelihoods and that of their households	SM 7.1	Instances of young people and their households reporting sustainable livelihoods
		SM 7.2	% and stories of young people expressing increased agency and voice.
SM 8	Foundation's contribution to strengthening ecosystems to enable and accelerate inclusive and sustainable access to education and dignified and fulfilling work by young people at scale	SM 8.1	Ways in which Foundation-supported contributions have influenced or advanced policy environments to improve inclusive youth access to dignified and fulfilling work
		SM 8.2	Ways in which social and cultural norms have been supported by Foundation initiatives to enable inclusive youth participation in education, work and decision-making.
		SM 8.3	Instances of new collaborations (numbers, types and ways) and investments have been catalyzed by the Foundation and/or its Partners among ecosystem actors that strengthen practices and programs to accelerate and scale inclusive access to dignified and fulfilling work for youth.
SM 9	Extent to which partner institutions demonstrate stronger, more inclusive, and sustainable systems, with enhanced capacity to drive access education and dignified and fulfilling work for young women and men	SM 9.1	Instances of partner institutional strengthening demonstrating stronger, more inclusive and sustainable systems

Understanding the Measures and Metrics

Shared Measures 2.0

SM 1: Individuals that received and benefited from one or more Foundation-supported work enabling interventions

SM 1 Individuals that received and benefited from one or more Foundation-supported work enabling interventions							
Metric		Disaggregation	Definitions	Responsibility	Frequency	Data Source	Methods
SM 1.1	SM 1.1 # of individuals accessing work-enabling services (all categories)	- Gender (Male/Female) - Rural/Urban (follows Country definitions) - Enterprises: Women/Youth/PWD /RDP-Led/Owned; Size (MSME based on country specific definition)	“Accessed” = participant formally registered/received the enabling service (loan disbursed, input package received, internship placement confirmed, digital gig accessed)	Implementing Partners	Quarterly	Partner service delivery records, financial transaction records, placement databases	Document review, sample verification, beneficiary surveys
SM 1.2	SM 1.2 % of individuals completing Foundation-supported training, skilling, or education interventions (a, b, c)	- Type of Education Institutions: TVET; Secondary; Higher-level - RDP/IDP - Disability (PWD) - Age (Absolute Age) - Sector/Thematic Focus (Foundation Definition by BI)	“Completion” = participant fulfills the minimum requirements of a structured intervention (training hours, course modules, credential/certificate)	Implementing Partners	Annual	Partner administrative data, training records, certification lists	Routine monitoring, validation of completion lists
SM 1.3	Foundation-supported participants perceptions of relevance, quality and utility interventions	Intervention type (Foundation Definition by BI)		Partner Impact synthesis	Annual	Surveys, Focus Group reports	

SM 2: Foundation-supported Young people transition in to a higher level of education*

SM 2 *Foundation supported Young people transition into a higher level of education*

Metric		Disaggregation	Definitions	Responsibility	Frequency	Data Source	Methods
SM 2.1	% of Foundation-supported youth transitioning to the next level of education	Youth segment - Gender (Male/Female) - Rural/Urban (follows Country definitions) - Type of Education Institutions: TVET; Secondary; Higher-education (under/postgrad) - RDP/IDP/ Disability (PWD) - Socio-economic status if available - Type of support received (scholarship, training, skills, support) - Intervention type (Foundation Definition by BI) - Education level transitioned from/to: Education pathway (secondary → TVET, secondary → tertiary, tertiary → postgraduate, bridging → accredited program or training)	Transition = enrolment in the next level of accredited education within 12 months of completing previous level	Implementing partner Foundation	Annual	Partner Databases and Administrative data bases Enrolment, completion, progression, graduation records, Support type and duration, as well as socioeconomic data on participants from admission records Surveys & Follow-up Tools. Tracer studies, Alumni surveys and databases, Mobile or online follow-up platforms Partner narrative and delivery reports, and insights derived from tracking systems and qualitative data collection.	Quantitative Tracking annually Use unique identifiers to track individual youth across education levels, from admission to completion. Apply cohort analysis to measure transitions over time, across programs, disciplines, sectors and institutional types. Surveys & Tracer Studies. Use technology to conduct periodic follow-ups (6–12 months post-program). Digital tools (SMS, WhatsApp, online forms) applied for cost-effective data collection, and Apurva for qualitative insights. Mixed Methods Complement tracking with qualitative insights annually (e.g., interviews, focus groups) to understand barriers and enablers of transition, institutional enablers and insights (faculty and educators), and visualise youth journeys to map transition pathways. Partner Quarterly reports include key transition indicators and insights in narrative and MEL reports. Partners that use student tracking systems have this data.
					Annual		
					Quarterly/ Semi-annual		

SM 3: Representation of young people, particularly young women, in higher end value chains/sub-sectors with growing economic potential

SM 3 Participation of young people, particularly young women, in higher end value chains/sub-sectors with growing economic potential

Metric		Disaggregation	Definitions	Responsibility	Frequency	Data Source	Methods
SM 3.1	% and stories of Foundation supported youth accessing work in higher end value chains/sub sectors (prioritised by in RoadMaps/ Strategies)	a) Youth segment (Gender; Age; Rural/Urban; PWD/IDP/Refugee) b) Enterprise type (Youth-led/Women led; Size (SMSMEs) c) Sub-sector d) Intervention Type e) Value chain node	Definition: Higher-value work refers to roles or enterprises within sectors identified by the Foundation and partners as having strong and growing economic potential . It captures both wage and self-employment, where youth transition from low-return or informal activities (such as subsistence farming, petty trade, casual labor) into more productive, higher-return, formal, or growth-oriented opportunities. Supported sub-sectors are those prioritized in national or program roadmaps and strategies. Example: A young man previously earning daily wages as a on-farm worker establishes a small-scale processing business with Foundation support. Similarly, a young woman selling airtime cards transitions into a licensed mobile money agent after training and access to digital finance tools.	IP and Foundation	Annual	Foundation supported youth (including youth-owned enterprises) Businesses/Enterprises	Data will be collected through routine Impact Monitoring systems (partner reporting, tracer studies, and youth follow-up surveys) and validated during Strategic Reviews which will triangulate quantitative data (% of youth in higher-value roles) with qualitative evidence (youth stories, enterprise case studies) to assess both scale and depth of youth participation in higher-value chains/sub-sectors. Partner level baseline

SM 4: Foundation-supported enterprises growing and creating work opportunities for youth, particularly young women

SM 4 Foundation-supported enterprises growing and creating work opportunities for youth, particularly young women

Metric		Disaggregation	Definitions	Responsibility	Frequency	Data Source	Methods
SM 4.1	% of enterprises showing growth through increased revenue	- Gender of owner (Male/Female) - Rural/Urban (follows Country definitions) - Enterprises:	Revenue Growth measures the percentage increase in annual revenue for enterprises, indicating financial success and market expansion	IP & Foundation	Annually	Foundation-supported enterprises database submitted to DPO	Partners will submit the number and data through quarterly reports using standardized templates, that detail list of enterprises supported, and the nature of financial and non-financial support provided to the enterprises. As part of the impact monitoring processes, the IPO will gather data on revenue, market expansion, and number of new jobs created for each of the enterprises sampled for the monitoring study.
SM 4.2	% of enterprises showing growth through market expansion / diversification	- Women/Youth/PWD/RDP-Led/Owned; Size (MSME based on country specific - Age of owner (Absolute Age) - Sector/Thematic Focus	Market Expansion measures the number of new markets entered by enterprises, showcasing their ability to scale and reach new customer segments. This also includes new products and services, and new industry	IP & Foundation		Foundation-supported enterprises database submitted to DPO	
SM 4.3	Average # of work opportunities accessed by youth from Foundation-supported enterprises	(Foundation Definition by BI) - Intervention type (Foundation Definition by BI) - Vulnerability	Employment Growth measures the number of new work opportunities created by enterprises, reflecting their contribution to economic development and job creation. This is a requirement for non-youth owned enterprises.	IP & Foundation		Foundation-supported enterprises database submitted to DPO	

SM 5: Foundation-supported youth accessing new, additional, or improved work (wage or self-employment).

SM 5 Foundation-supported youth accessing new, additional, or improved work (wage or self-employment).

Metric		Disaggregation	Definitions	Responsibility	Frequency	Data Source	Methods
SM 5.1	Number of employed youth (wage and self employment)	• Pathway – Primary & Secondary • New; Improved; Additional • Gender (Male/Female) • Rural/Urban (follows Country definitions) • RDP/IDP • Disability (PWD) • Age (Absolute Age) • Sector/Thematic Focus (Foundation Definition by BI) • Intervention type (Foundation Definition by BI)	Youth-in-Work (YIW) refers to the total number of young people who have gained new, additional, improved, and sustained employment, either through self-employment or wage employment, as a direct result of the Foundation's support. New: Refers to Youth who have transitioned into work for the first time or after a period of unemployment or non-engagement in work Additional: This category refers to young people who were already working but have accessed an extra work opportunity (e.g., a second income-generating activity, gig work) that adds to their livelihood. Improved: This refers to youth whose existing work conditions have improved—such as higher income, respect at workplace, sense of purpose, and reputation—through program interventions.	IP & Foundation	Quarterly	Foundation-supported Youth database submitted to DPO	IPs keep track of they young people they support and report the number of youth-in-work directly supported by the program in FLUX. IPs also submit the identifiable list of youth, with relevant disaggregation to Foundation’s DPO system. <i>Partners should ensure this component is included in the consent with the young people.</i>

SM 6: Foundation-supported young people are engaged are accessing dignified and fulfilling work

SM 6 Foundation-supported young people are engaged are accessing dignified and fulfilling work

Metric		Disaggregation	Definitions	Responsibility	Frequency	Data Source	Methods
SM 6.1	% of Youth accessing Dignified & Fulfilling Work	• Gender (Male/Female) • Rural/Urban (follows Country definitions) • RDP/IDP • Disability (PWD)	% of youth who are reported as Youth-in-Work, who have reliable income and experience at least one of the other markers: reputable work, workplace respect, and a sense of purpose	IP & Foundation	Quarterly	Foundation-supported Youth database submitted to DPO	IPOs will conduct quantitative surveys of a representative sample of Foundation-supported youth to assess the level of progression to dignified & fulfilling work. This will be measured as part of Impact Monitoring on a continuous basis.
SM 6.2	Youth experiences in accessing dignified & fulfilling work	• Age (Absolute Age) • Sector/Thematic Focus (Foundation Definition by BI) • Intervention type (Foundation Definition by BI)	Qualitative experiences in the journey to accessing dignified & fulfilling work	IP & Foundation	Quarterly	Foundation-supported Youth database submitted to DPO	Qualitative methods including interviews with selected Youth-in-Work, digital diaries to understand challenges around accessing dignified & fulfilling work

SM 7: Foundation-supported young people reporting improvement in their lives and livelihoods and that of their households

SM 7 Foundation-supported young people reporting improvement in their lives and livelihoods and that of their households

Metric		Disaggregation	Definitions	Responsibility	Frequency	Data Source	Methods
SM 7.1	Instances of young people and their households reporting improvements in their lives and livelihoods	- Gender (Male/Female) - Rural/Urban (follows Country definitions) - RDP/IDP/Disability (PWD)	The Sustainable Livelihoods Framework asks people to rate their own assets in six different areas—basic needs, health, money, skills and employability, sense of self, and connections—and consider how they can strengthen each area. As people stabilize and move towards a sustainable livelihood, they use fewer coping strategies and more asset-building strategies	Foundation	Every 2 years	Survey with youth and their households. Stories of young people	Measure quality of life and resilience of youth and their households using the Sustainable Livelihoods Framework which measures livelihood stages indicating progress towards sustainable livelihoods. This will be measured qualitatively (stories of young people) and quantitatively using the sustainable livelihoods framework, and in relation to their households.
SM 7.2	% and stories of young people expressing increased agency and voice.	- Gender (Male/Female) - Rural/Urban (follows Country definitions) - RDP/IDP/Disability (PWD)	Agency refers to the capacity to make decisions about one's life and important issues. Voice refers to the capacity to speak up and be heard. Voice includes confidence, self-efficacy, self-awareness, and ability to articulate your needs	Foundation	Every 2 years	Survey with youth	Conduct surveys and interviews to assess individual agency and voice. We use qualitative and quantitative evidence from stories, focus groups, interviews and household and participant surveys.

SM 8: Foundation's contribution to strengthening ecosystems to enable and accelerate inclusive and sustainable access to education and dignified and fulfilling work by young people at scale

SM 8 *Foundation's contribution to strengthening ecosystems to enable and accelerate inclusive and sustainable access to education and dignified and fulfilling work by young people at scale*

Metric	Disaggregation	Definitions	Responsibility	Frequency	Data Source	Methods
SM 8.1	Ways in which Foundation-supported contributions have influenced or advanced policy environments to improve inclusive youth access to dignified and fulfilling work	- Type of policy/regulatory changes (new/implementing existing etc) - Youth segment targeted by the policy/regulatory shift	Policy is an umbrella term and refers to the rules, regulations, strategies, priorities, bulletins and circulars that determine actions in a sector or policy area. These can exist at the level of a locality, state/province/region, or national government. A change in an existing policy is an update or additional component or enhancing the effectiveness of the implementation of existing policies.	IPs+Foundation	Every two years	Partners reports, stakeholder testimonies, strategic reviews. Evidence will draw on both qualitative and quantitative data; and can be gathered through interviews, focus group discussions and surveys; and should include impact stories, case studies
SM 8.2	Ways in which social and cultural norms have been supported by Foundation initiatives to enable inclusive youth participation in education, work and decision-making.	Youth segment affected by the shift in social/cultural norms (gender, disability, displacement)	Social & Cultural Norms refer to observable and verifiable changes in attitudes, practices, and discourse within families, communities, institutions, and media that influence the way youth, especially young women and marginalized groups, are able to participate in dignified and fulfilling work. Note: Changes include amplifying or changing existing norms	IPs & Foundation	Every two years	
SM 8.3	Instances of new collaborations (numbers, types and ways) and investments have been catalyzed by the Foundation and/or its Partners among ecosystem actors that strengthen practices and programs to accelerate and scale inclusive access to dignified and fulfilling work for youth.	Areas/Sectors of collaboration, Types of actors (Government/civil society/academia/etc., Types of collaborations,	Collaborations and investments encompass the leveraging of resources (technical, financial, and in-kind), the expansion of initiatives into new areas through adoption, and the participation of new partners, funders, and institutions, governmental and non-governmental, arising within or alongside initiatives where the Foundation has played a catalytic or convening role.	IPs & Foundation	Every two years	

Measures Explained

SM 9: Extent to which partner institutions demonstrate stronger, more inclusive, and sustainable systems, with enhanced capacity to drive access education and dignified and fulfilling work for young women and men.

SM 9 *Extent to which partner institutions demonstrate stronger, more inclusive, and sustainable systems, with enhanced capacity to drive access to dignified and fulfilling work for young women and men*

Metric	Disaggregation	Definitions	Responsibility	Frequency	Data Source	Methods
SM 9.1	Instances of partner institutional strengthening demonstrating stronger, more inclusive and sustainable systems - Country - Sector - Type of institution	Self-assessment of institutional strengthening covers the following areas: STRENGTH OF ORGANIZATIONAL EFFECTIVENESS INDICATORS - Organizational systems - Governance & leadership - Staff Capacity & Engagement INCLUSION INDICATORS - Ethical & inclusive practices - Autonomy & partnerships SUSTAINABILITY INDICATORS - Financial sustainability - Adaptive innovation LINK TO DETAILED DEFINITIONS	IPs and Foundation	Annually	IP Self-assessment	IP conducts self-assessment annually using institutional strengthening self-assessment rubric, and surfaces learnings on improvements over time. The Foundation documents instances of partner institutional strengthening

Summary of Disaggregation Variables

- Gender (Male/Female)
- Disability
- Displacement (Refugees/Internally Displaced)
- Rural/Urban (follows Country definitions)
- Vulnerability – Currently using SES
- Enterprises: Women/Youth/PWD/RDP-Led/Owned; Size (MSME based on country specific definition)
- Type of Education Institutions: TVET; Secondary; Higher-level
- Age (Absolute Age)
- Sector/Thematic Focus (Foundation Definition by BI)
- Intervention type (Foundation Definition by BI)